

# Federico De Cillia

Data Science Manager & AI Solutions Architect

*I architect AI systems and build reliable AI agents that augment people.*


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With over 12 years of experience designing end-to-end Data & AI solutions, I turn ambiguous business problems into production systems people actually use, working across discovery, solution architecture and hands-on delivery.
I lead the Data Science team for DTC Category & Merchandising at EssilorLuxottica, where I set engineering standards in the Databricks lakehouse and architect end-to-end AI systems used to craft the perfect assortment for 18,000+ stores worldwide.
In parallel I run AI trainings and selected consulting work, and contribute to open source, staying hands-on with how teams adopt AI.
I build daily with Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, Google Antigravity, GitHub Copilot.

**Full portfolio & live case studies** federicodecillia.github.io

| 12+ yrs | 100+ | 50+ |
|---|---|---|
| AI & DATA SCIENCE | AI PROJECTS SHIPPED | CLIENTS SERVED |

## EXPERIENCE

**Data Science Manager - DTC Category & Merchandising** · EssilorLuxottica — 2021 – present
- Founded the DTC AI Data Science team from the ground up (from 1 to 5 people) and manage its portfolio of 20+ Data & AI projects a year, from architecture to production, supporting the 200+ person business team that manages the assortment of 18,000+ stores across 100+ markets.
- Built the team's Databricks lakehouse (medallion architecture, Unity Catalog) and its engineering kit (AGENTS.md, branching and worktrees, PR-based CI/CD, Declarative Automation Bundles, automated tests).
- Built forecasting, anomaly-detection, clustering, optimization and recommendation engines on governed retail data foundations.
- Delivered 8 web apps to serve 100+ business users.
- Shipped Genie Agents and LLM systems giving the DTC Category & Merchandising team natural-language access to enterprise data and advanced conversational analytics.

**Co-founder & Technology Lead** · Porta Moneta APS, nonprofit volunteer role — 2022 – present
- Built the digital operating layer: website, WeGrocery (open-source platform, versioned releases), AI chatbot, digital membership.

**AI Consultant & Trainer** · Freelance — 2019 – present
- Delivered AI agents, LLM chatbots, machine learning models and automation to 50+ clients across 100+ projects globally.
- Run tailored AI trainings (generative AI, LLMs, agents, automation) for audiences from beginners to technical teams; weekly public series on practical AI use (52 AI Tips, LinkedIn).
- Open source: easyprophet, a Python forecasting package on PyPI (versioned releases, tests, CI); WeGrocery, a buying-group ordering platform in production with versioned releases.

**Senior Data Scientist** · Nielsen — 2017 – 2021
- Delivered AI, BI & ML models on audience and panel data across 10+ countries, and built scalable data pipelines.

**Data Scientist** · Bip, Business Integration Partners — 2016 – 2017
- Pioneer of Bip xTech CoE. Delivered ML & NLP models at Sky Italy to improve retention and upselling marketing strategies.

**Data Science Consultant** · SAS / Value Lab — 2015 – 2016

**Data Mining Junior Officer** · Università Bocconi, Alumni Association — 2015

## EDUCATION

**MSc & BSc in Statistical Sciences** · University of Padua (Erasmus, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, 2012) — 2008 – 2014

**IT Technical Diploma (Perito Industriale, Informatica)** · ITI F. Severi, Padua — 2004 – 2008

## SKILLS

**AI engineering:** LLMs, AI agents, AI solution architecture, RAG, MCP, tool use, evals, fine-tuning, prompt engineering, context engineering, loop engineering

**ML & data science:** Python, R, Supervised & Unsupervised Learning, Time Series Forecast, NLP, MLOps, embeddings & vector DBs

**Data & cloud:** SQL, Spark, Databricks, Delta Lake, Unity Catalog, Declarative Automation Bundles, Databricks Genie, Power BI, Azure, AWS, GCP, Postgres, Docker, Git & CI/CD

**Apps & web:** FastAPI, Streamlit, TypeScript, Next.js, React, Vercel

**Delivery:** solution architecture, discovery & scoping, technical advisory

**Languages:** Italian (native), English (C1), Spanish (B2)

## CERTIFICATIONS, RECOGNITIONS

Nova 111 Top Talent Italy (2023)
Databricks Machine Learning Professional
Azure Data Scientist Associate (DP-100)
Tackling the Challenges of Big Data · MIT
Deep Learning Specialization · deeplearning.ai
ML for Data Science & Analytics · Columbia University
Machine Learning Specialization · University of Washington
Python for Data Science · University of California